

Reading Notes 1st, Week 2

Basic Information

- Date: 2025/03/08
 - Link: [Why New Zealanders are emigrating in record numbers - The Economist](#).
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Source Text and Paragraph Analysis

Why New Zealanders are emigrating in record numbers

The government may not be able to reverse the trend

“**DITCH** the winter chill” and “expand your horizons in sunny South East Queensland!” reads one newspaper advert, **luring** New Zealand’s health-care workers towards a new life in Australia. “Warmer days and higher pays”, enthused another, last year, from the Australian state’s police service. Kiwis who chose “policing in **paradise**” could look forward to 300 days of annual sunshine and a A\$20,000 (\$12,500) relocation bonus, it declared. ***(Many media publicized the better living in Australia than in New Zealand)***

For many New Zealanders that is an easy sell. They are leaving their country in record numbers. Almost 129,000 residents emigrated last year—40% above the pre-pandemic average for this century. It is not a case of last in, first out. The majority of those leaving were New Zealanders, rather than immigrants returning home, creating a net loss of 47,000 citizens. ***(The specific situation and amount of the emigration of New Zealanders)***

New Zealand, though a settler country, is also shaped by emigration. Its small economy and relative lack of opportunity have long driven young New Zealanders towards what they call the “overseas experience”, fanning fears of **brain drain**. Proportionate to its population of 5.3m, it has one of the largest **diasporas** in the OECD, a club of mostly rich countries. Emigration **ebbs** and flows: the last **spike** occurred in 2012, near the end of the financial crisis. As the pandemic **raged**, many **expats** returned to **hunker** behind closed borders, but the outflow quickly resumed. Recently, New Zealand has been **in a rut**. The economy is in **recession** and unemployment has risen. Outgoing Kiwis **grumble** about costly housing and a crime surge. ***(The reasons of the emigration of New Zealanders, especially for economy)***

Unlike most, they have an alternative when times get tough: they are free to live and work in Australia, and vice versa. Almost 15% of them are now based “**across the ditch**”. It is not just that Australia’s economy has **weathered** the cost-of-living crisis better. The income gap between the pair has been growing for decades. Adjusted for purchasing power, Australia’s per person GDP is about a third higher than New Zealand’s. Its pensions are more generous, and its centre-left Labor government has made it easier for Kiwis to get passports and benefits. By comparison, New Zealand is “a sinking boat”, says one transplant on a Facebook group for Kiwi expats. Australia is “best for an easy life”, writes another. ***(The comparison in economy of Australia and New Zealand to show the reason of the emigration to Australia)***

In the past, fears of brain drain have proved **overblown**. Young expats have generally returned, and governments have **offset** losses by letting in immigrants from countries such as India and China. The result was a “brain exchange”, says Paul Spoonley, a sociologist at New Zealand’s Massey University. But there is a risk of that changing, he argues. First, he says, it is no longer just young New Zealanders who are leaving, but more experienced professionals and extended families. Second, inward immigration is now slowing. After a post-pandemic spike, it plunged by around a third last year, though the population is still growing. Christopher Luxon, the prime minister, says the solution is “to build a long-term proposition where New Zealanders actually choose to stay”. But that has not proved easy. In 2009 John Key, then prime minister, set out to “match Australia by 2025”. In Wellington, the capital, some now joke that a more realistic goal would be to “beat Fiji by 2050”. ***(The opinions of professors toward the phenomenon of "brain exchange and the worries of them)***

Significant Words and Phrases

Words:

- ditch:
A informally usage as "throw away".
- lure:
attract someone.
- Kiwis:
Another name for New Zealanders.
- paradise:
A place with blessing and welfare.
- diaspora:
The spread of population

- spike:
The increasing fiercely of something.
- ebb:
A gradual decline.
- rage:
violent state of something.
- expat:
emigrant; the abbreviation of expatriate.
- hunker:
someone or somewhere old.
- recession:
decline.
- grumble:
compliant in a low tone.
- overblown:
overstate
- offset:
a compensate equivalent.

Phrases:

- ebb and flow:
ups and downs with regulation.
 - brain drain:
The loss of intelligent and professional personnel.
 - in a rut:
stuck in difficulty.
 - across the ditch:
A informal statement of emigrating from New Zealand to Australia.
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Topic Idea

This essay introduces the situation of the emigrating of New Zealand, the reasons why they emigrate and the worries of professors toward this situation.

Structure

It begins at the luring of the media to New Zealanders to motivate readers to read. Then it introduces the reasons why New Zealanders emigrate to Australia and compares the gap in economy of Australia and New Zealand to prove those reasons.

At last the author shares some opinions of professors and expresses his worry about the situation.